

The Delhi Drupal Meetup v1.0

This meetup saw Drupal enthusiasts turning up from different parts of the country, such as Srinagar, Meerut, Bijnor and the NCR region.

On March 1, 2009, LUG@IITD hosted the Delhi Drupal Meetup at IIT Delhi. It was the first of its kind in the country, with the aim of ensuring contribution from all the participants. The meetup saw a turnout of 70 people with laptops, all set to code for Drupal. Anyone attending the meetup had to write a Drupal theme or module. This interesting event was managed by just four volunteers.

Kicking off with Drupal theming

The event was kick-started by Vivek Khurana's talk on Drupal theming. He walked the audience through how a Drupal theme is structured, the core components of a Drupal theme, the concepts of blocks and regions, followed by templating engines available with Drupal themes. The talk had examples of a theme with a template engine and one without. The talk concluded with how to create separate designs for specific pages and creating a theme from scratch.

Initialising the module

Pratul Kalia spoke on Drupal module development. He explained the Drupal module system, its architecture and the Drupal menu system. He used examples to explain things like the Drupal module node API, using external PHP modules in Drupal modules, and how to start creating a module from scratch.

Clash of the Titans

Subsequently, participants were given a break to think about the ideas discussed, over a cup of tea and *samosas*. Participants interacted with each other to prepare for the real coding. During the post tea session, all participants sat down for a contest on theming and module development. While the code competition was going on, Supreet Sethi and Piyush Verma took the lead in guiding the Drupal newcomers in development problems that they were facing.

While basic support was provided by Supreet and Piyush, Vivek, Mir Nazim and Pratul helped participants with the more advanced issues related to database design and debugging PHP code.

"And the winners are..."

After two hours of coding, a couple of participants were ready with themes, but the module developers demanded extra time. It was unanimously decided that module developers should be given two days to submit their entries.

The theme contest was judged by the participants that very day, and Kaushal Kishore won the prize for the best theme. He won a bag full of goodies and a one-year *LFY* subscription.

The module development contest was judged three days later and Ravi Gupta won the first prize. He developed a module to find the difference in the database schema of two Drupal installations, developed from the point of view of easily moving features from the development server to the production server. He, too, won a bag of goodies and a one-year *LFY* subscription. The judges decided to award a consolation prize to Amit Sethi, a student of IP University, for his module that allows linking keywords in a Drupal node to Wikipedia and Google search results.

The bags of goodies were sponsored by OSSCube, while Srijan Technologies sponsored the snacks for participants, and dinner for the volunteers and speakers. *LFY* magazine sponsored the one-year subscription for the winners. The event was organised by Mayank Kumar, Gajender Khanna, Sangeet Kumar and Vivek Khurana of LUG@IITD.

By: Vivek Khurana reporting on behalf of LUG@IITD.

► Amit Sethi with his prize

